

Chris Kenst

STRATEGIC COMMUNITY LEADER & TECHNICAL ADVOCATE

Blog: kenst.com

GitHub: github.com/ckenst

X/Twitter: [@ckenst](https://twitter.com/ckenst)

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/ckenst

Two decades of software testing leadership combined with deeply rooted influence in the global testing ecosystem. Former President of the Association for Software Testing (AST) and founder of TestingConferences.org, with a proven track record of bridging the gap between highly technical platforms and the developer communities who rely on them.

✂ TECHNICAL CONTENT & DOCUMENTATION

Mailinator Documentation Architecture

- **The Project:** Orchestrated a comprehensive restructuring of Mailinator's developer documentation, shifting the user journey from disconnected technical notes to a highly intuitive, success-oriented framework.
- **The Quickstart Guide:** Authored the end-to-end onboarding experience to explicitly minimize time-to-first-API-call for incoming engineers.
- **Developer SDK Utilities:** Built production-ready JavaScript Client Examples to provide copy-pasteable context and code patterns for professional automation engineers.

Educational Writing & Developer Guides

- **Complex Technical Concepts:** Published "Foundation Models and Beyond," translating macro-level Generative AI and Large Language Model shifts into practical paradigms for modern automation practitioners.
- **DX-Focused Tutorials:** Authored deep-dives on local configuration friction—such as configuring Ghost environments with active template hot-reloads—demonstrating real empathy for local workflows.

🌐 COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP & ADVOCACY

TestingConferences.org (Founder & Maintainer)

Conceived, built, and continuous manager of the open-source industry directory for global QA and testing events.

Open Source Impact: 180+ global contributors • 1,500+ commits • 111 GitHub Stars • 239 Forks

- **Strategic Ecosystem Partnerships:** Cultivated multi-year brand integrations and sponsorship alignments with industry market leaders, including **Applitools**, to optimize industry reach.

Association for Software Testing (AST)

- **Executive Board Leadership:** Elected as President and long-term Board Member, driving digital transformation efforts and upgrading public-facing community engagement strategies.
- **Instructional Mentorship:** Active instructor across Black Box Software Testing (BBST®) programs, teaching context-driven methodologies to scale automation capabilities worldwide.

PRODUCT-ENGINEERING FEEDBACK LOOP

The Veteran Practitioner Perspective

- **Applitools Implementation:** Architected, verified, and scaled Applitools Visual AI regression testing matrices at enterprise scale across growth organizations (including Promenade Group and Laurel & Wolf). I understand the core ROI, implementation bottlenecks, and developer workflow patterns.
- **Proactive Demo Applications:** Currently engineering *YouGotMailinator*, a purpose-built technical sandbox ecosystem designed explicitly to model complex E2E automation structures and upcoming visual baseline validation scenarios.
- **Bi-Directional Feedback Architecture:** 20-year history interfacing directly as a peer to core Product and Systems Engineering. Expert at surfacing nuanced friction inside SDK interfaces and turning complex developer interactions into structured engineering roadmap items.